

NAME

chdir, fchdir – change working directory

LIBRARY

Standard C library (*libc*, *-lc*)

SYNOPSIS

```
#include <unistd.h>
```

```
int chdir(const char *path);
```

```
int fchdir(int fd);
```

Feature Test Macro Requirements for glibc (see **feature_test_macros(7)**):

```
fchdir():
```

```
    _XOPEN_SOURCE >= 500
```

```
    || /* Since glibc 2.12: */ _POSIX_C_SOURCE >= 200809L
```

```
    || /* glibc up to and including 2.19: */ _BSD_SOURCE
```

DESCRIPTION

chdir() changes the current working directory of the calling process to the directory specified in *path*.

fchdir() is identical to **chdir()**; the only difference is that the directory is given as an open file descriptor.

RETURN VALUE

On success, zero is returned. On error, *-1* is returned, and *errno* is set to indicate the error.

ERRORS

Depending on the filesystem, other errors can be returned. The more general errors for **chdir()** are listed below:

EACCES

Search permission is denied for one of the components of *path*. (See also **path_resolution(7)**.)

EFAULT

path points outside your accessible address space.

EIO An I/O error occurred.

ELOOP

Too many symbolic links were encountered in resolving *path*.

ENAMETOOLONG

path is too long.

ENOENT

The directory specified in *path* does not exist.

ENOMEM

Insufficient kernel memory was available.

ENOTDIR

A component of *path* is not a directory.

The general errors for **fchdir()** are listed below:

EACCES

Search permission was denied on the directory open on *fd*.

EBADF

fd is not a valid file descriptor.

ENOTDIR

fd does not refer to a directory.

STANDARDS

POSIX.1-2008.

HISTORY

POSIX.1-2001, SVr4, 4.4BSD.

NOTES

The current working directory is the starting point for interpreting relative pathnames (those not starting with '/').

A child process created via **fork**(2) inherits its parent's current working directory. The current working directory is left unchanged by **execve**(2).

SEE ALSO

chroot(2), **getcwd**(3), **path_resolution**(7)